Merijn Kersten

Creative technologist & spatial developer

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PROFILE — 9+ YEARS OF EXPERIENCE

As a developer I've contributed with a lot of enthusiasm to projects across AR, VR, mobile games and interactive installations. Connecting the virtual and physical world and my drive to explore the edges of what technology can do are central to my work. Every project is another chance to give people a fresh perspective.

EXPERIENCE

2025-07 — now

XR consultant & networking engineer

Marechaussee · Apeldoorn, NL

Defence — Unity · C# · VR · Multiplayer networking

For the Dutch military police I work on connecting VR players inside a complex training system that has been in development for years, given the security I had to build a lot of networking components myself and learn how they work in detail.

2024-11 — 2025-07

Unreal & AI engineer

Philips · Eindhoven, NL

Health care — Unity · C# · VR · Vision Pro · Blender

At Philips immersive lab we started a project where we dived into research papers and built the first Unreal metahumans that realistically mimic a persons heartbeat in face coloration. This we use to generate synthetic data to train LLM's in detecting heartbeat from a distance more accurately and for more varied skintypes

2024-06 — 2024-11

XR engineer

Alliander · Arnhem, NL

Energy — Unity · HoloLens · UWP · Azure & AWS · Figma · WebGL

For Alliander I worked in a small dedicated team to build HoloLens software that lets field crews enrich their surroundings with information from the grid database, making the construction of voltage stations more efficient. I was responsible for the development, optimisation and UX of these apps.

2024-03 — 2024-06

XR & AI engineer

Philips · Eindhoven, NL

Health care — Unity · C# · VR · iOS · Blender

At Philips' immersive lab I visualised medical equipment like CT scanners and new procedures, I built VR experiences that are both educational and informative used to familiarise people with new medical developments and to present them at trade fairs.

2022-01 — 2024-02

Creative technologist

Wonderment · Amsterdam, NL

Immersive reality — Unity · Lightship VPS · Cesium · Node.js · Firebase · Python · PyTorch · WebGL

I joined Wonderment to follow my enthusiasm for AR, building location-based experiences: visualisations, games and web applications, plus R&D into image recognition with machine learning in Unity and Lens Studio. My biggest focus was VPS and Cesium, technology that pins AR to the outside world with centimetre accuracy, to enrich environments with geodata like GIS, 3D map tiles and geoJSON.

2020-06 — 2022-05

Game developer

Popcore · Berlin, DE

Casual games — Unity · ECS · CI/CD · UI & UX · Blender

Looking for a new challenge I joined Popcore to build hyper-casual games for a huge Android and iOS audience. I ran live-ops on titles like Parking Jam, Pull the Pin and Wrecking Ball, and implemented new game modes, multiplayer features and tools for editors and level designers, everything on an ECS framework for speed and flexibility. Popcore is where I grew fastest as a developer.

2019-03 — 2020-03

App developer (freelance)

Zwijsen · Tilburg, NL

Publishing — Unity · AR · iOS · Android

As a freelancer for publisher Zwijsen I built AR seek-and-find and audiobook apps for children's books. Doing everything from designing, developing, testing and publishing on store pages. The apps were opened through QR codes in the books and gathered tens of thousands of downloads with exclusively positive reviews.

2019-01 — 2020-07

XR & app developer

DTT · Amsterdam, NL

Digital agency — Unity · VR & AR · iOS · Android · HLSL · Shader Graph · WebGL

At DTT I started as an intern and grew into helping lead a team of developers across VR, Android, iOS and web projects. My responsibilities included selecting and mentoring new developers, improving the team's ways of working, and building features like deep linking, iOS plugins, XR, multiplayer, in-app purchases and optimisation.

2016-09 — 2018-09

VR developer

Letink Design · Enter, NL

Immersive reality — Unity · VR & AR · Blender · After Effects

My developer career began at Letink Design, building VR and AR applications for the construction sector, tourism and government, publishing them online and supporting clients on location at trade fairs and events. On the side I made explainer animations, built interactive installations and assembled the office PCs myself.

EDUCATION

2014-10 — 2019-06

Creative media & game technology (Bachelor's degree)

Saxion · Enschede, Netherlands

Studied game development across individual and group projects: games, web applications, interactive installations and 3D. For my graduation project I researched AR-framework compatibility through cloud anchors and built my own framework integrating ARCore and ARKit before ARFoundation existed.

2017-01 — 2017-08

Minor in indie game development

OAMK · Oulu, Finland

Led a team building an indie game telling the story of the Sámi, the last tribe of Europe. I guiding the project through every round and we won first place for the year.

CERTIFICATES

Unity Certified Professional - Programmer

STACK

Unity · C# · ECS
AR - ARKit · ARFoundation · Lightship VPS
VR - Quest · Vision Pro · HoloLens
JavaScript · TypeScript · React · Node.js
Python · computer vision · AI & LLMs
Firebase · Azure · CI/CD
Blender · Figma

LANGUAGES

Dutch - native
English - fluent
German - semi fluent
French - basic
Finnish - very basic

OFF THE CLOCK

Music production, baking, cooking, church, history, fitness